

The awkward moment between your PhD and your future job

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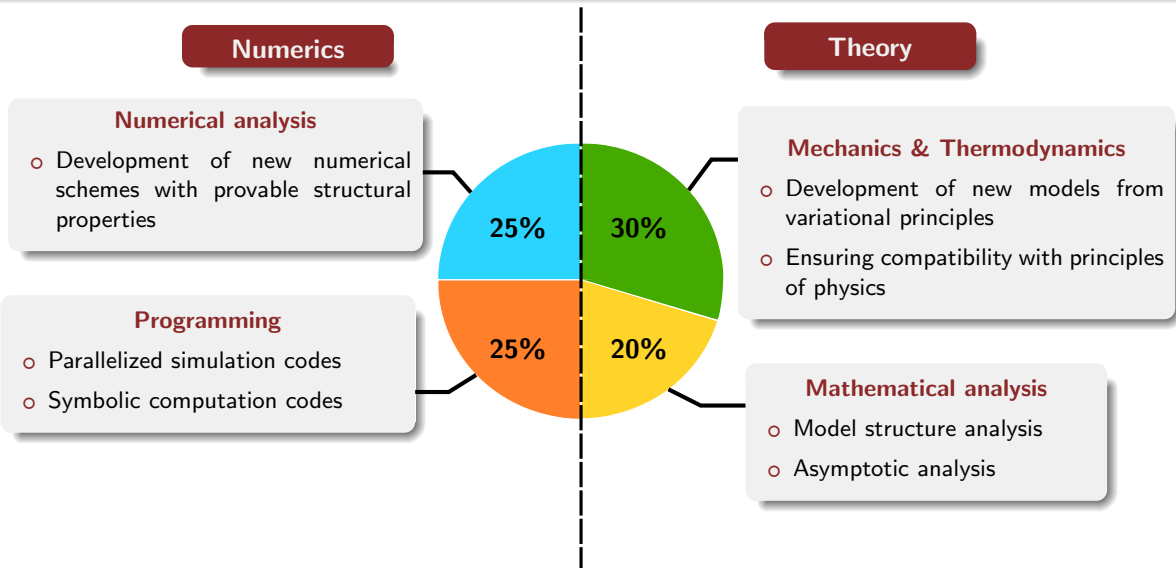
My career preview: Every experience leaves a mark

2013–2016	Engineering Diploma in applied maths Ecole Nationale d'Ingénieurs de Tunis
2016–2017	Master's Degree in Multiphase Flows, Energetics and Combustion Aix-Marseille University
2017–2020	PhD in Applied Mathematics Institut de Mathématiques de Toulouse and Aix-Marseille University
2021–2025	Postdoctoral Researcher (1Y)+ assistant professor (3Y) University of Trento
2025–present	Assistant Professor (Maître de Conférences) Bordeaux INP – IMB Team CSM, INRIA Team Cardamom.

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2017–2020	PhD in Applied Mathematics Institut de Mathématiques de Toulouse and Aix-Marseille University Acquired experience in hyperbolic PDEs and Mechanics
2021–2025	Postdoctoral Researcher (1Y)+ assistant professor (3Y) University of Trento Acquired experience in Numerical analysis
2025–present	Assistant Professor (Maître de Conférences) Bordeaux INP – IMB Team CSM, INRIA Team Cardamom. Eager to learn new things here!

Researcher profile: Built from previous experience



The Postdoctoral Period

Choosing a postdoc:

1. Choose the person with whom you will work, before the city where you will go.
2. Leave your comfort zone and go abroad. See how research works in a different place.
3. Try to build your own network and show your availability for postdoc some months before finishing your thesis.

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The main question

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Who funds your postdoctoral positions ?

1. The team where you go has secured a funding. (Yay!)
2. You write your own project and get your own money. For example Marie-curie Fellowships, DFG (Germany), Humboldt foundation, etc ...

My postdoctoral projects attempts

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- ✓ **September 2022 (yes same year):** Applied for a **NextGenEU Young Researchers Grant**, open only to winners of a Marie-Curie or a **Seal of Excellence**.
⇒ Funding for three years to pursue my own project with full autonomy.

Seal of excellence: It means your project has merits but will not be funded.
(like the Friendzone =)).

Applying for a Permanent Position

Lessons learned

For each application, find someone who knows the ropes — the unspoken rules and the right strategy. *Not everything is written.*

Practical advice

CNRS and INRIA: Contact the teams you wish to apply with around **3 to 6 months in advance.**

My applications in the previous year:

Position	Receivable	Auditioned	Ranked	Awarded
CNRS 41-02	✓	✗	✗	✗
CNRS 41-03	✓	✗	✗	✗
INRIA Bordeaux	✓	✓	✓	✗
INRIA Nice	✓	✓	✓	✗
MCF INP-BDX	✓	✓	✓	✓

Explore New Grounds and Leave the Nest!

Do not be afraid of doing postdocs:

1. You get free time for your research without distractions.
2. Usually well-paid.
3. Extends your network, gets you new perspectives.

"The frog in the well knows nothing of the sea."

— Japanese proverb

"A tree does not grow tall in the shade of another."

— African proverb

"The world is a book, and those who do not travel read only one page."

— St. Augustine